

Space counts useful squares

Chess Math

THE IDEA

Space is not simply the number of advanced pawns. Useful space gives your pieces safe squares and makes the opponent's coordination difficult. Counting controlled central squares can help, but a square attacked by a pawn is not automatically a secure outpost.

WORKED EXAMPLE

Pawns on d4 and e4 influence c5, d5, e5, and f5. If Black can attack that center with ...c5 or ...f5, White must be ready to defend or transform it. More space creates more territory to maintain.

TRY IT BEFORE READING ON

What should follow a count of your central pawn controls?

ANSWER AND REASONING

Check which central squares your pieces can actually occupy, which pawn breaks challenge them, and whether your advanced pawns can be defended efficiently.

TAKE THIS INTO YOUR NEXT GAME

Measure space by the freedom it creates for pieces.